

THAT FLYING FEELING

AS SUMMER HOLIDAYS beckon and international flights resume after two years, we know—and so does the airline industry—that you're dusting those discarded holiday plans. Indian carriers are planning to expand ultra-long-haul flights, and also seeking smarter bilateral agreements, more open sky markets and enhanced code-share arrangements. Boeing and Airbus are elbowing each other to showcase their hottest planes... The buzz is back.

—MANISH PANT



11.8 MILLION

**NUMBER OF
BUSINESSES
SUPPORTED
WITH 100
PER CENT
COLLATERAL-
FREE LOANS
UNDER ECLGS
AS OF MARCH 11,
2022; 95.21 PER
CENT OF THESE
WERE MSMEs**



MASKS GONE, BUT COVID?

Breathe. Smile. Live. Yes, these are our top emotions after several states ended all curbs related to Covid-19 and opened up economic activities. Cities like Delhi and Mumbai have announced that there will be no challans for not wearing face masks. However, public health experts have called the decision premature, especially in the wake of the fast spread of the virus in countries like China and South Korea. The suspense continues.

—NEETU CHANDRA SHARMA

THUNDER DOWN UNDER

The growing bond between India and Australia got a fillip on April 2, when the governments of the two countries signed an Economic Cooperation and Trade Agreement (ECTA). According to government estimates, the pact will propel bilateral trade between the two countries to \$100 billion (annually) over the next five years from the present level of \$60 billion. Trade in goods is likely to almost double to \$50 billion in the same period, and services trade is also likely to touch \$15 billion. Such trade pacts provide market access for India's exports, which have crossed \$400 billion this year. Target: \$1 trillion by 2030.

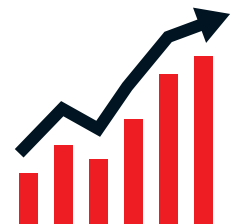
—RAJAT MISHRA



Electric Leader

TATA MOTORS HAS closed the financial year 2021-22 on a high. According to data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations (FADA), the auto major's market share grew from 7.8 per cent in FY21 to 11.45 per cent in FY22, making it the third-largest passenger vehicle maker in India after Maruti Suzuki and Hyundai. And in electric vehicles, the company is the clear No. 1. With two electric cars—Nexon EV and Tigor EV—in its fold, Tata Motors dominates the market with more than 85 per cent market share after selling 15,198 vehicles. Electrifying, we say.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



AGONY OR ECSTASY?

We're talking stock markets here. You made a pile in FY22, now for FY23. Here's an expert's view. Mohit Nigam, Head-PMS, Hem Securities, says, "The easy part of creating money is over... We have a cautious view for FY23." Nigam says the next 12 months will be volatile and the major risk will be a rise in commodity prices, which could lead to increase in input costs and margin pressures. So, there.

—RAHUL OBEROI